

GEOGRAPHICAL INDICATION APPLICATION

1. Application Form & Applicant Details

Name of Applicant Organization:
Lipa City Kapeng Barako Producers Association (Sample)

Type of Applicant:
Association of Coffee Producers

Address:
Lipa City, Batangas, Philippines

Authorized Representative:
Juan Dela Cruz
President, Lipa City Kapeng Barako Producers Association

Contact Information:
Email: info@kapengbarakolipa.ph
Contact Number: +63 9095405923

2. Geographical Indication Name

Proposed Geographical Indication (GI):
"KAPENG BARAKO NG LIPA"

Alternative Name:
"Lipa Kapeng Barako"

Product Category:
Agricultural Product – Coffee Beans

Scientific Name:
Coffea liberica

3. Product Description

Kapeng Barako ng Lipa is a premium Liberica coffee grown within the territorial boundaries of Lipa City, Batangas. The coffee is recognized for its strong aroma, bold flavor profile, naturally high caffeine content, and distinct fruity and floral notes.

The beans are larger than those of Arabica and Robusta varieties and possess unique sensory characteristics that have established Kapeng Barako as one of the most culturally significant coffee products in the Philippines.

Distinct characteristics include:

- Large bean size
- Strong and intense aroma

- Full-bodied flavor
- Low acidity
- Fruity and floral undertones
- Traditional cultivation methods practiced by local farmers

The reputation of Kapeng Barako has been established through generations of production and consumption in Batangas Province, particularly in Lipa City.

4. Geographical Area Description

The geographical area covered by this application consists exclusively of Lipa City, Batangas, Philippines.

Geographical Coordinates:
Approximately 13.94° N Latitude and 121.16° E Longitude

Boundaries:

North: Municipality of Cuenca
South: Municipality of San Jose
East: Municipality of Mataas na Kahoy
West: Municipality of Malvar

The area is characterized by:

- Volcanic soil influenced by Taal Volcano
- Elevation ranging from 100–400 meters above sea level
- Tropical climate with distinct wet and dry seasons
- Average annual rainfall suitable for Liberica coffee cultivation

These environmental conditions contribute significantly to the quality and distinctive characteristics of Kapeng Barako grown in Lipa City.

5. Product Specification Manual

A. Raw Material

Species: *Coffea liberica*

Source: Coffee trees cultivated exclusively within Lipa City.

B. Cultivation Standards

1. Coffee trees must be planted within the designated geographical area.
2. Farmers shall maintain good agricultural practices.
3. Organic and sustainable farming methods are encouraged.
4. Farm records shall be maintained for traceability purposes.

C. Harvesting Standards

1. Only mature red coffee cherries shall be harvested.
2. Selective hand-picking shall be practiced.

3. Immature and damaged cherries shall be excluded.

D. Processing Standards

1. Cherries shall be processed within 24 hours after harvesting.
2. Drying shall achieve moisture content between 10–12%.
3. Sorting and grading shall remove defective beans.
4. Storage shall protect beans from moisture contamination.

E. Quality Requirements

Physical Characteristics:

- Large bean size
- Uniform appearance
- Moisture content not exceeding 12%

Sensory Characteristics:

- Strong aroma
- Full-bodied taste
- Distinct floral and fruity notes
- Minimal bitterness
- Low acidity

6. Evidence of Link Between Product and Geographical Origin

Historical Evidence

Lipa City became the center of the Philippine coffee industry during the nineteenth century. Historical records indicate that Batangas, particularly Lipa, achieved international recognition for its coffee production and export activities.

Cultural Evidence

Kapeng Barako has become an integral part of Batangueño identity and heritage. Traditional cultivation and processing practices have been transmitted across generations of farming families.

Environmental Evidence

The volcanic soil composition, elevation, rainfall patterns, and climate conditions of Lipa City contribute directly to the flavor, aroma, and quality characteristics of Kapeng Barako.

Scientific Evidence

Agricultural studies indicate that the environmental conditions present in Batangas support the cultivation of high-quality *Coffea liberica*. The interaction between soil composition, climate, and farming practices influences bean development and sensory attributes.

Market Reputation

Kapeng Barako is widely recognized by consumers, traders, and tourism stakeholders as a distinctive coffee product associated with Lipa City and Batangas Province.

7. Inspection and Traceability System

The producer association shall maintain a traceability and verification system to ensure compliance with GI standards.

The system shall include:

- Farmer registration records
- Farm location verification
- Production records
- Harvest monitoring records
- Batch identification numbers
- QR code-based traceability mechanism
- Product verification reports

8. Certification Request

The applicant respectfully requests the registration of "KAPENG BARAKO NG LIPA" as a Geographical Indication under applicable Philippine laws and regulations governing Geographical Indications.

The applicant certifies that the product possesses qualities, characteristics, and reputation essentially attributable to its geographical origin and that all information submitted in this application is true and correct.

Prepared by:

Lipa City Kapeng Barako Producers Association

Date: